AUSTRALIAN GOVERNMENT (FICTIONAL)

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Cloud Infrastructure Modernisation Services

RFP Reference: GOV-2026-ICT-0042

Issuing Agency: Department of Digital Transformation (DDT)

Issue Date: 12 May 2026

Submission Deadline: 17:00 AEST, 30 June 2026

Lodgement: AusTender portal

This is a fictional procurement document created for a software demonstration. The issuing agency, requirements, and all details are invented. It is modelled on the structure of real Australian government ICT procurement documents.

1. Introduction and Background

The Department of Digital Transformation (DDT) delivers digital services to Commonwealth agencies and operates two leased datacentres in the Australian Capital Territory. The lease for both facilities expires on 30 June 2027 and will not be renewed. DDT therefore seeks a suitably qualified vendor to migrate its hosted workloads to Microsoft Azure and to provide ongoing managed platform services.

DDT's current environment comprises approximately 580 virtual machines (predominantly Windows Server 2012 R2 and 2016, with a small Red Hat Enterprise Linux estate), 36 Microsoft SQL Server instances, and approximately 410 TB of stored data. Workloads include citizen-facing digital services classified as Tier-1, internal corporate systems, and several legacy applications earmarked for modernisation.

This RFP sets out the mandatory and desirable requirements against which proposals will be evaluated. Respondents must address every mandatory requirement individually, providing verifiable evidence for each claim made. Unsupported claims will be disregarded by the evaluation panel.

2. Definitions

'Agency' means the Department of Digital Transformation. 'ISM' means the Australian Government Information Security Manual. 'IRAP' means the Infosec Registered Assessors Program. 'Tier-1 workload' means a production workload designated business-critical by the Agency. 'MTTR' means mean time to recovery for Priority 1 incidents. 'IPP' means the Commonwealth Indigenous Procurement Policy. 'Cutover window' means the agreed period during which a workload group is transitioned to the target platform.

3. Scope of Services

The scope of this procurement comprises: (a) discovery, dependency mapping, and wave planning for all in-scope workloads; (b) design and build of an Azure landing zone compliant with the ISM at the PROTECTED level; (c) migration of all in-scope workloads to Azure; (d) modernisation of nominated application workloads, including containerisation where assessed as suitable; (e) managed platform and security operations services for an initial term of three years; and (f) full decommissioning support for both existing datacentres prior to lease expiry.

4. Mandatory Technical Requirements

Each requirement below is mandatory unless marked otherwise. Responses must address each requirement under its reference number, citing verifiable evidence (project references, certifications, audited reports, or named personnel) for every claim.

MR-1 - Migration track record (Mandatory, High priority)
The vendor must demonstrate proven experience migrating Windows Server 2012/2016 workloads to Azure IaaS and PaaS services, with a minimum of three completed migrations of comparable scale (500 or more virtual machines each), evidenced by contactable client references for each migration cited.

MR-2 - Service levels and recovery (Mandatory, High priority)
The proposed managed service must achieve a 99.95% availability SLA for Tier-1 production workloads, with continuous monitoring tooling, documented incident response procedures, and a mean time to recovery (MTTR) under 30 minutes for Priority 1 incidents. Respondents must evidence actual achieved availability and MTTR figures from current or recent operations.

MR-3 - Data sovereignty and security accreditation (Mandatory, High priority)
All Agency data must remain within Australian Azure regions (Australia East and Australia Southeast) at all times, including backup and disaster recovery copies. The vendor must hold current ISO/IEC 27001 certification covering its cloud delivery operations, and must evidence an IRAP assessment of its proposed platform architecture at the PROTECTED level under the ISM.

MR-4 - Migration execution (Mandatory, High priority)
The vendor must provide a zero-downtime migration approach using Azure Site Recovery or an equivalent replication-based mechanism, including rehearsal cutovers and tested rollback plans. Production cutover windows must not exceed four hours per workload group. Respondents must evidence prior cutovers completed within equivalent windows, including any data loss incidents.

MR-5 - Application modernisation capability (Mandatory, Medium priority)
The vendor must demonstrate an established application modernisation capability, including production experience designing, deploying, and operating containerised workloads on Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) at scale, and must provide a modernisation roadmap approach for the Agency's nominated legacy applications.

5. Mandatory Commercial Requirements

MR-6 - Pricing structure (Mandatory, High priority)
Pricing must be submitted as a fixed-price schedule for Years 1, 2, and 3 of the engagement, with annual escalation capped at CPI plus 2%, inclusive of all licences, migration tooling, professional services, and transition costs. Respondents should evidence prior acceptance of equivalent fixed-price structures.

MR-7 - Payment terms (Mandatory, Medium priority)
A milestone-based payment schedule must be provided, with each milestone's completion certified by the DDT Project Director prior to invoicing, and payment terms of net 30 days from receipt of a correctly rendered invoice.

6. Mandatory Team and Governance Requirements

MR-8 - Key personnel (Mandatory, High priority)
The proposed delivery team must include a named Project Manager holding a current PMP or PRINCE2 Practitioner certification with a minimum of seven years of cloud migration programme experience, evidenced by a curriculum vitae. Substitution of key personnel requires the Agency's prior written approval. The vendor must also name a lead cloud architect holding current Microsoft Azure architecture certification.

MR-9 - Governance cadence (Mandatory, Low priority)
The vendor must operate a monthly steering committee with Agency executives and provide fortnightly written progress reports covering schedule, risk, and financial status.

7. Mandatory Legal and Compliance Requirements

MR-10 - Privacy and breach notification (Mandatory, High priority)

The vendor must comply with the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth), the Australian Privacy Principles, and the Notifiable Data Breaches scheme. Any eligible or suspected data breach affecting Agency data must be notified to the Agency within 24 hours of discovery. Respondents must evidence their privacy management framework and tested breach response procedures.

MR-11 - Indigenous Procurement Policy participation (Mandatory, Medium priority)

Consistent with the Commonwealth Indigenous Procurement Policy, a minimum of 10% of the total contract value must be delivered through registered Indigenous businesses as subcontractors or suppliers. Respondents must identify the Indigenous businesses they propose to engage, the scope each will deliver, and any existing partnership history.

MR-12 - Cryptographic agility (Mandatory, Medium priority)

Recognising forthcoming Australian Signals Directorate guidance on post-quantum cryptography, the vendor must provide a quantum-safe cryptography transition plan describing how platform cryptography (data in transit, data at rest, and key management) will migrate to post-quantum algorithms by 2030, including interim crypto-agility measures.

8. Desirable Requirements

DR-1 - Sustainability reporting (Desirable)

Quarterly reporting of the carbon footprint attributable to the Agency's Azure consumption, with year-on-year reduction targets.

DR-2 - Cost optimisation (Desirable)

An ongoing FinOps practice with quarterly optimisation reviews and a shared-savings mechanism for realised cost reductions.

9. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals that fail to address any mandatory requirement will be excluded from further evaluation. Compliant proposals will be scored as follows: Technical capability and migration approach - 40%; Price and commercial terms - 30%; Team experience and governance - 20%; Risk management and compliance - 10%. Proposals scoring below 60% overall will not proceed to the negotiation stage. The Agency may seek clarification, conduct reference checks, and require presentations from shortlisted respondents.

10. Submission Instructions

Proposals must be lodged via the AusTender portal no later than 17:00 AEST on 30 June 2026. Late submissions will not be accepted under any circumstances. Proposals must be submitted as a single PDF of no more than 60 pages, structured to address each requirement reference (MR-1 through MR-12, DR-1 and DR-2) in order. Questions must be lodged through the AusTender forum no later than 20 June 2026; answers will be published to all registered respondents.

11. Conditions of Tender

The Agency is not bound to accept the lowest-priced or any proposal. The Agency may discontinue this process at any time. Respondents bear their own costs of participation. Proposals must remain valid for 120 days from the submission deadline. The successful respondent will be required to enter into the Commonwealth contract attached as Annex C (not reproduced in this demonstration document), including provisions for liquidated damages, key personnel, and step-in rights.

Appendix A - Current Environment Summary

Virtual machines: approximately 580 (430 Windows Server 2012 R2/2016, 95 Windows Server 2019, 55 RHEL 8). Databases: 36 SQL Server instances (2014-2019), total 48 TB. Storage: approximately 410 TB across SAN and NAS tiers. Network: dual 10 Gbps links between datacentres; ExpressRoute not yet provisioned. Identity: Active Directory (2016 functional level) with Entra ID Connect synchronisation already in place. Backup: nightly full to disk with 35-day retention; quarterly archive to tape.

Workload tiers

Tier-1 (24 applications): citizen-facing digital services and payment systems; 99.95% availability required; cutover windows strictly limited to four hours. Tier-2 (61 applications): internal corporate and case-management systems. Tier-3: development, test, and archive workloads. Legacy modernisation candidates: 8 applications nominated for containerisation or re-platforming assessment during the engagement.

Appendix B - Indicative Timeline and Risk Allocation

Indicative programme timeline

Contract execution: August 2026. Discovery and landing zone build: August - November 2026. Migration waves: December 2026 - March 2027. Modernisation assessments: from January 2027. Datacentre decommissioning and lease exit: complete by 30 June 2027. Managed services steady state: from April 2027 for the remainder of the three-year term. Respondents may propose an alternative timeline provided the lease-exit date is met.

Risk allocation principles

The vendor bears delivery risk for migration execution, including rollback costs arising from failed cutovers. The Agency bears risk for delays caused by Agency-side approvals exceeding agreed turnaround times. Liquidated damages apply to missed lease-exit milestones attributable to the vendor. Caps on liability will be negotiated with the preferred respondent within Commonwealth contracting norms; unlimited liability applies for breach of privacy or security obligations.

Glossary of evaluation terms

'Compliant' means the proposal fully addresses the requirement with verifiable evidence. 'Partially compliant' means the proposal addresses the requirement but evidence is incomplete or the capability is not yet demonstrated at the required scale. 'Non-compliant' means the requirement is not addressed or no evidence is provided. Mandatory requirements assessed as non-compliant result in exclusion; partial compliance on mandatory requirements must be justified with a credible remediation plan.